



PetSmart Search Audit

Algolia Search Intelligence · 2026-06-19

SEARCH AUDIT SCORECARD

PetSmart scores 5.8/10

Strong Foundation, Unactivated Upside

0

CRITICAL

5

MODERATE

5

STRENGTHS

3/10 Semantic / NLP Search	4/10 Query Suggestions / Empty State	5/10 Content Commerce / Front-End UX	5/10 Dynamic Facets & Personalization	5/10 Recommendations & Merchandising
8/10 Intent Detection	8/10 Merchandising Consistency	9/10 Latency	9/10 Typo Tolerance	9/10 Search Intelligence

15.98%

of searches on PetSmart.com end in nothing. About 1 in 6, roughly 100M dead-end searches a year.

Source: PetSmart Algolia search analytics (30-day window)

You said. We found.

You said

"We really making sure that we have an open platform, that we can then hook in different pieces of technology to change the experience over time."

Greg Fancher, EVP IT & CITO

[SiliconANGLE - commercetools Elevate 2024 ↗](#)

We found

The AI search component is plugged in but switched off – NeuralSearch dead-ends on conversational queries.

Your leaders vs the field

What your execs are saying

CITO commits to an open platform to 'hook in different pieces of technology' [Exec Statement ↗](#)

New CCO owns digital + marketing, calls the moment 'pivotal' [Media Quote ↗](#)

Chewy CEO publicly applying AI to search relevance & discoverability [Competitor Move ↗](#)

What competitors are running

Chewy: Self-built (AWS Elasticsearch + OpenSearch)

Petco: Reflektion (Sitecore Search)

Amazon (Pet): Proprietary A9/A10 + COSMO + Rufus/Alexa GenAI (Bedrock)

Walmart (Pet): Proprietary GenAI search (Azure OpenAI + retail LLMs; 'Sparky')

Conversational queries dead-end at zero results

A SHOPPER SEARCHED

"grain free food for a senior dog with kidney issues; calming treats for an anxi..."

WHAT HAPPENED

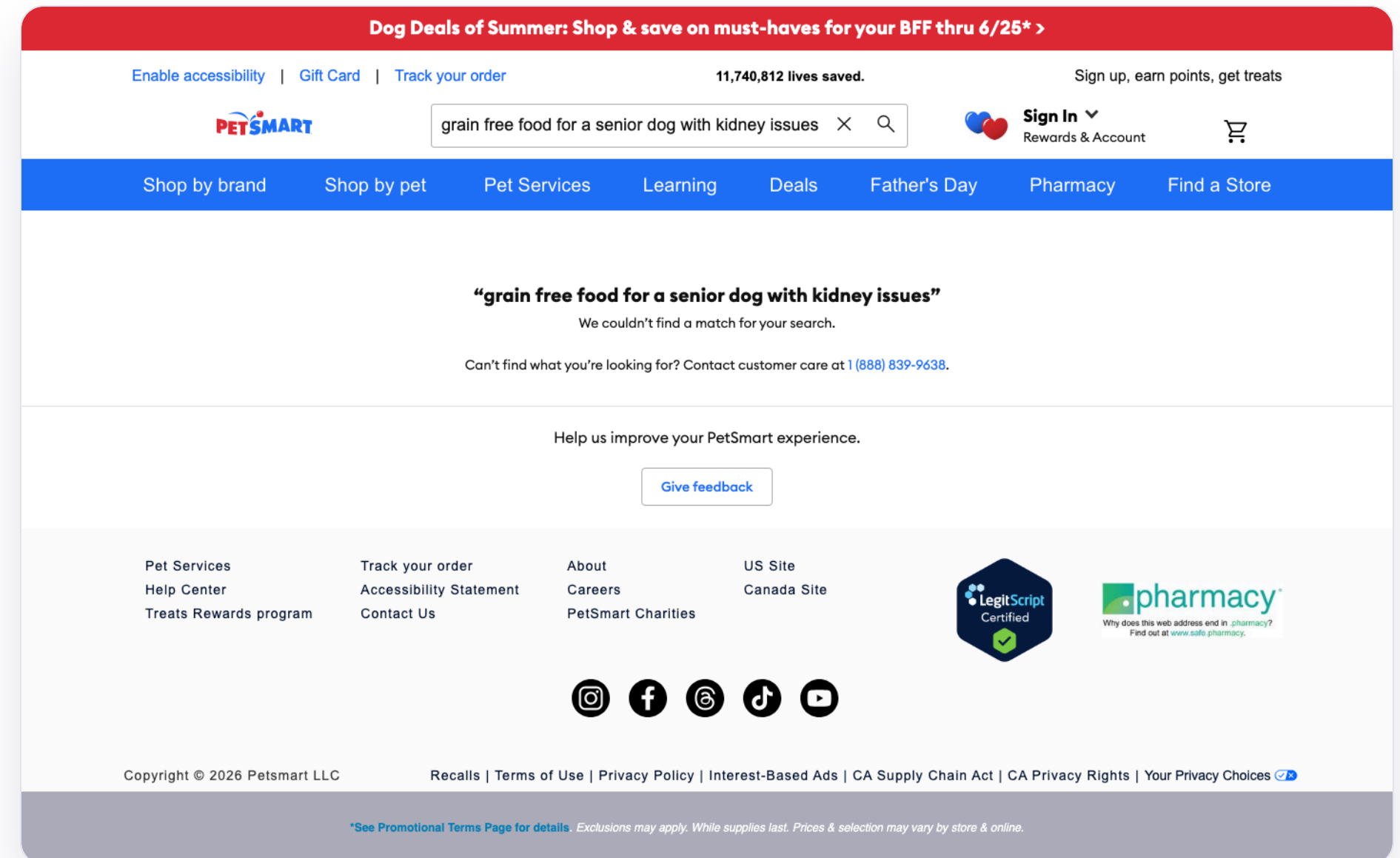
All three multi-attribute natural-language queries return 0 results and a bare 'We couldn't find a match' dead-end with no suggestions or fallbacks. Identical on mobile...

THE COST TO PETSMART

PetSmart pays for an AI search platform but conversational shoppers - the fastest-growing query shape in the AI-shopping era - hit a wall.

Source: PetSmart Algolia search analytics (30-day window)

PROOF BIG W: +7% search conversion, -10% search exits after migrating to Algolia [case study](#) ↗



AI Personalization inert - userToken present, not re-ranking

A SHOPPER SEARCHED

"joint health (anonymous vs dog-browsed session); salmon"

WHAT HAPPENED

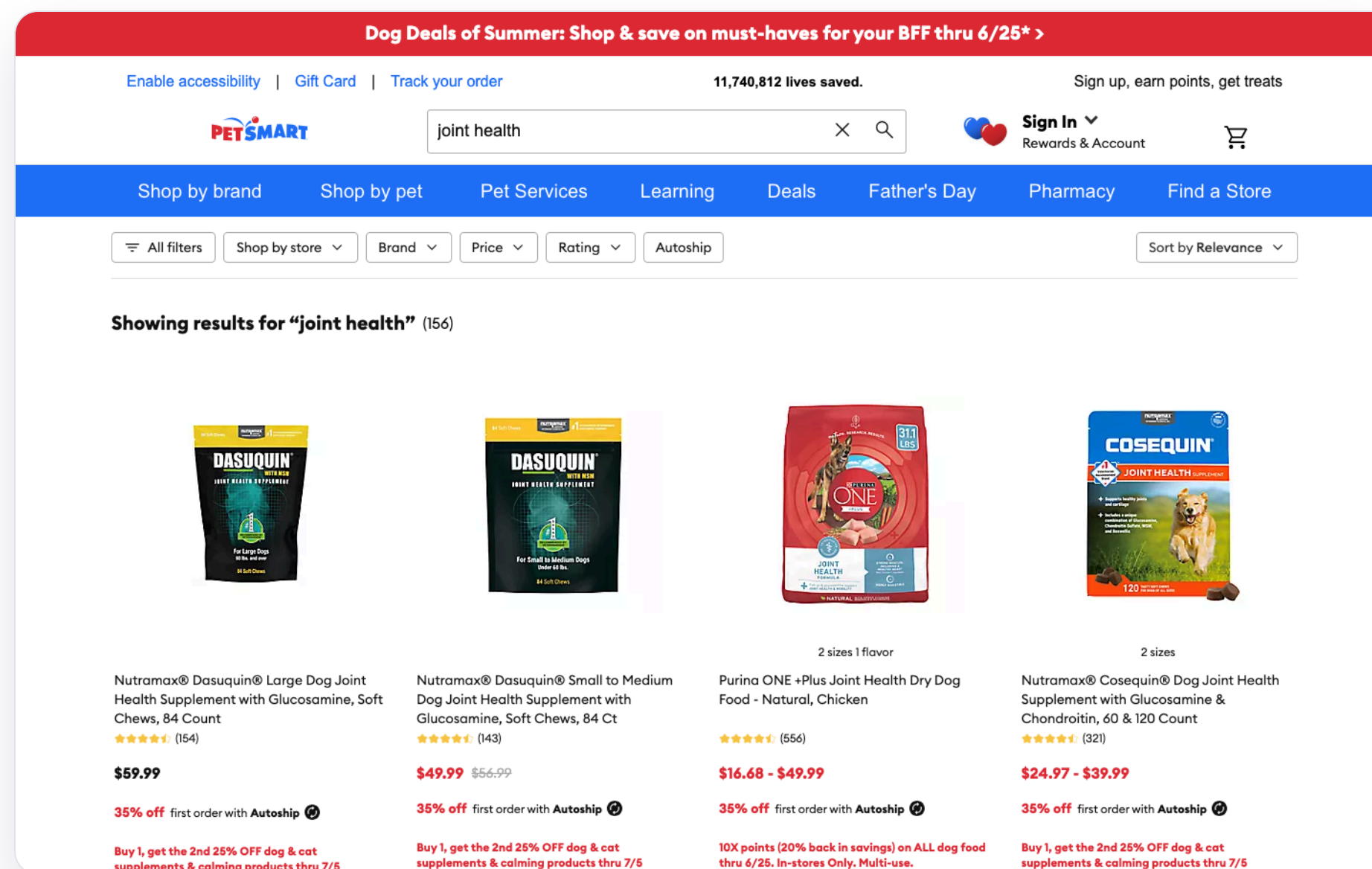
Anonymous and dog-browsed 'joint health' return a pixel-identical result set (156 hits, same top-4, same SSR queryID fd48591c). 'salmon' returns an all-dog top-4 for eve...

THE COST TO PETSMART

PetSmart already invests in personalization for loyalty (CITO on record) but the search/browse surface - where intent is highest - ignores the sessio...

Source: PetSmart Algolia search analytics (30-day window)

PROOF Decathlon Singapore: +50% conversion with personalized omnichannel search [case study](#) ↗



Zero-results null state is a bare dead-end

A SHOPPER SEARCHED

"zxqwbnm (gibberish)"

WHAT HAPPENED

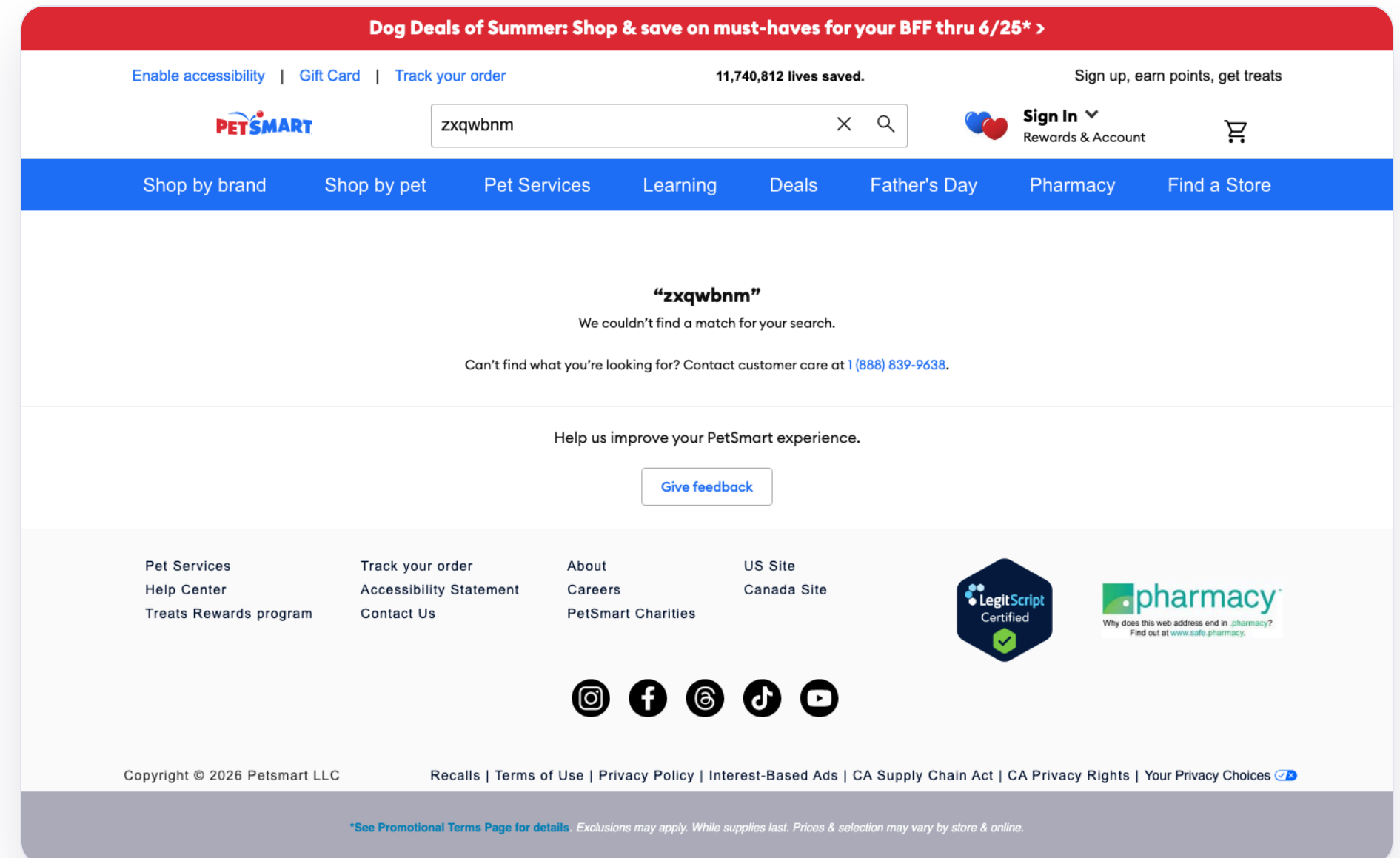
0 results renders only 'We couldn't find a match', a phone number, and a 'Give feedback' button - no suggestions, no products, no recovery. PetSmart's own analytics show...

THE COST TO PETSMART

PetSmart already owns the Query Suggestions index that could recover these sessions - it's live in SAYT but never reaches the page where the shopper...

Source: PetSmart Algolia search analytics (30-day window)

PROOF PetSmart (self): +5–7% web conversion, +700bps product-view rate vs prior provider [case study](#) ↗



No Algolia Recommend cross-sell on results or PDP

A SHOPPER SEARCHED

"flea and tick prevention (results + Seresto PDP)"

WHAT HAPPENED

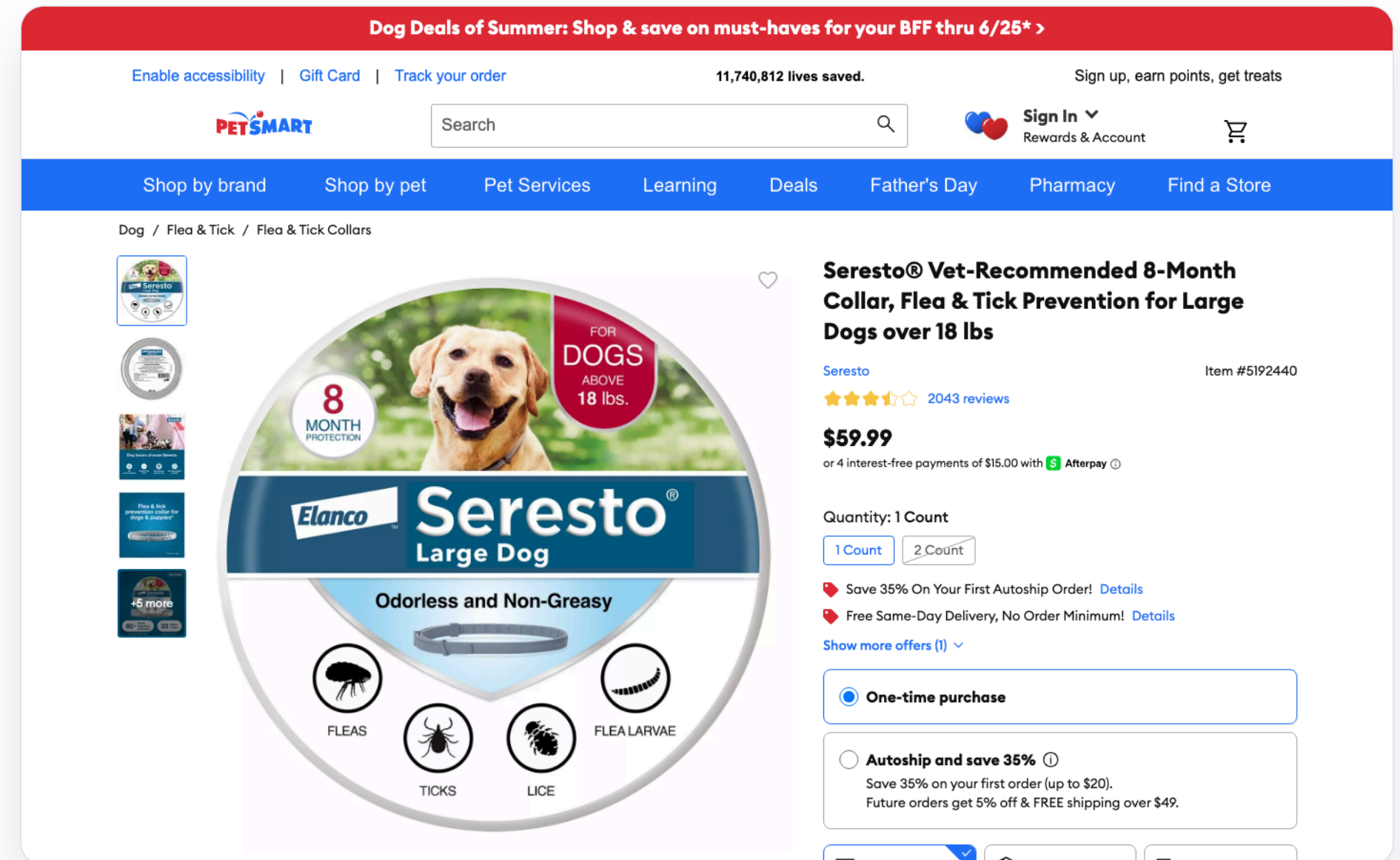
Results page has no FBT carousel; the Seresto PDP shows a generic 'you may also like' (Granify/Einstein) and an Ordergroove Autoship CTA, but no Algolia Recommend FBT (f...

THE COST TO PETSMART

Cross-sell revenue is leaking to fragmented off-Algolia vendors instead of the Recommend module bundled with the platform PetSmart already runs.

Source: <https://www.algolia.com/customers/bigw>

PROOF Revival Animal Health: +12% revenue conversions (pet-vertical, Algolia + BigCommerce) [case study](#) ➔



Why search is the battleground

~80%

of pet parents shop both online and in-store. Search is the front door to the omnichannel basket. Source: industry context

1.8x

site searchers convert versus non-searchers. The shoppers who search are your highest-intent buyers. [Industry Opportunity ↗](#)

81%

of US shoppers abandon after a failed search. Every dead end is a lost basket. [Industry Opportunity ↗](#)

Why act now

The clock is running

Amazon pet category +28.5% YoY; PetSmart organic flat-to-declining [Industry Risk ↗](#)

Chewy CEO publicly applying AI to search relevance & discoverability [Competitor Move ↗](#)

Your window is open

The platform to win is already in place. Activation is low-risk configuration on what you already own, not a migration.

commercetools replatform underway - native Algolia connector available [Partner Signal ↗](#)

What activating this delivers

+12% revenue conversions

Revival Animal Health. Closest pet-vertical proof point - a non-competing pet peer that lifted revenue conversions with Algolia, directly comp... [case study ↗](#)

+7% search conversion · +4.7% basket · -10% search exits · +4 NPS

BIG W. Strongest large-format-retail peer on a headless React stack (like PetSmart's Next.js). Maps to F1 (NLP/exits), F3 (zer... [case study ↗](#)

+50% conversion

Decathlon Singapore. Upper-anchor proof for the personalization activation (F2) - a specialty omnichannel retailer that lifted conversion 50...

[case study ↗](#)

A scoped proof of concept

- **commercetools co-sell to CITO Fancher.** Engage Algolia's commercetools alliance team for a joint play: standardize PetSmart's existing Algolia deployment onto the native commercetools conne...
-

- Activate NeuralSearch + zero-results recovery: Phase-1 quick win on the live p-US_products index: enable NeuralSearch and wire the existing Query Suggestions index into the zero-results...
-

- Turn on AI Personalization + consolidate Recommend: Activate AI Personalization + Dynamic Re-Ranking on the userToken/Insights data already flowing; move fragmented cross-sell (Granify/Einste...
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- Federate services + content, close web↔app parity: Federate grooming/training/Banfield services + Contentful help content into search; standardize on the native commercetools connector; veri...

THE ASK

**Prove it on your live
index in weeks, not
quarters**

Sources

- 1

Algolia customer case study - PetSmart [link ↗](#)
- 2

Algolia customer - BIG W [link ↗](#)
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Algolia customer story - Decathlon Singapore [link ↗](#)
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Algolia customer - Revival Animal Health [link ↗](#)
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PR Newswire - Jesica Duarte appointed CCO [link ↗](#)
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SimilarWeb - petsmart.com profile [link ↗](#)
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